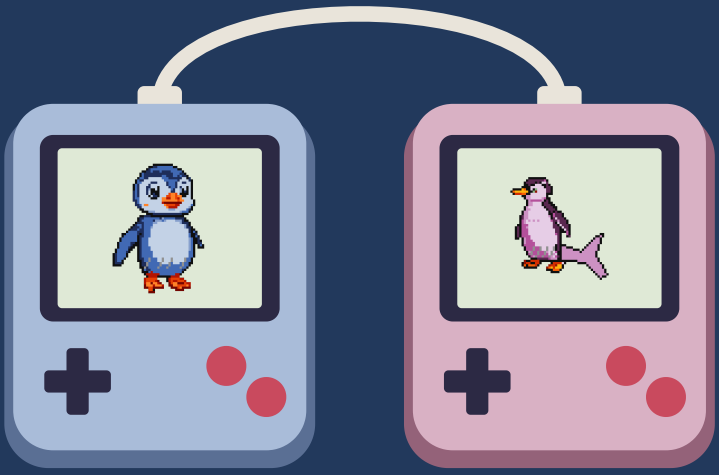
CONTEXT / CONTENT

DAEMONS

PLAYING TOGETHER

Trading, lending, gifts, meetings and friends' homes





For release **v11.348.1**, 2026-11-11 · every word quoted from the game is a DRAFT
A fan project for the Game Boy Advance. No ROM is in it, or anywhere in DAEMONS.

Contents

1 Playing together 3
What you need 3
Where it all lives 4

2 Joining the exchange 5
The hub's own companion 5
Everyone else: an invite code 5
A password, if you want one 6
A phone on its own 6

3 Trading 7
Offering one 7
Taking one 8
SYNC, and the game 9
As FireRed traded 9

4 Lending 11
Lending one 11
What a borrowed daemon may do 12
Calling it home 12

5 Giving 13
A daemon 13
An item 14

6 Evolving by trade 15
Two that need each other 15

7 Fair play 17

8 OUT TOGETHER 18
Meeting 19
What they may say 19

9 Friends and dreams at home 20
Friends 20
Dreams shared 20

10 Friends' homes: THE COMMONS 21
Linking your home 21
Trading with friends' homes 22

11 For the keeper 24
The hub 24
The commons 24

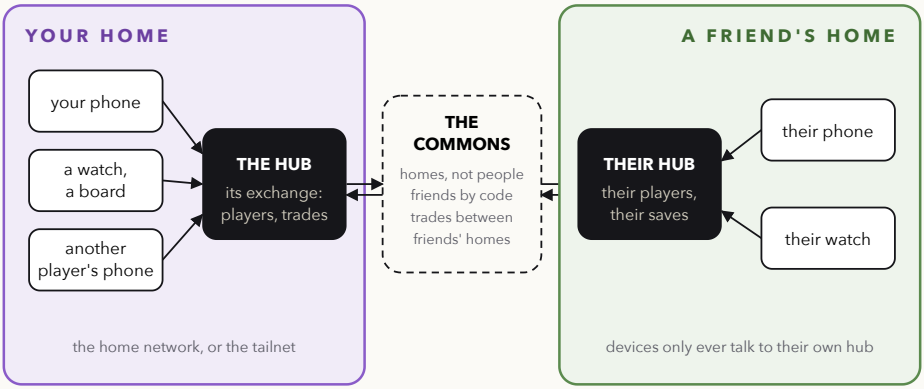
12 Under the hood 25

13 Coming next 26

CHAPTER 1

Playing together

DAEMONS is a game you play alone, on a Game Boy Advance or anything that pretends to be one. This book is about the parts that are not alone: trading a daemon with another player, lending one, giving one away, sending yours out to meet someone else's, and making friends with another household. All of it happens through **the companion**, the app and the small server that already carry your daemons when they are AWAY.



Where everything goes. Your phone and your devices talk only to your own home's hub. Trades between homes go through THE COMMONS, and only between homes that are friends.

What you need

- **Your game**, and **the companion** linked to it -- the app on your phone, iPad or Mac, or the site.
- **A hub**: the companion's server, on a computer or a small box at home. A household shares one. It keeps the players, the offers and the trades.
- **For now, the home network or the tailnet** (Tailscale) between your devices and the hub. Nothing in this book is on the open internet yet.

Every trade starts the same way: **SEND** the daemon from the game's party menu, so it is **AWAY** -- on your companion, not in your game -- and SYNC. Only a daemon AWAY can be traded, lent, given, or sent out to meet another.

Nobody needs to be online at the same time. You offer; another player takes it whenever they like; each of your games changes at its own next SYNC. The hub keeps everything in between.

Where it all lives

On the app, everything in this book is on **YOU**, under the trainer card: **TRADE**, then its cards one after another -- your offers, the offers made to you, your trades, gifts, OUT TOGETHER, friends, dreams shared, and, on the hub itself, THE COMMONS.

CHAPTER 2

Joining the exchange

Before you trade you join **the exchange** on your home's hub as a **player**: a name the others see beside the daemons you offer.



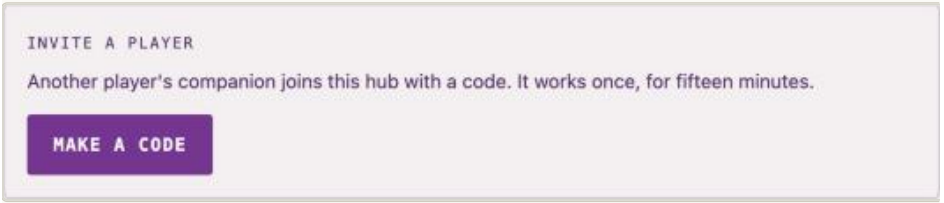
JOIN THE EXCHANGE: a name, the invite code from the hub, and a password only if you want one.

The hub's own companion

On the companion running on the hub, choose a name and JOIN. That is all: the hub knows itself.

Everyone else: an invite code

Any other player's companion -- another phone, a second computer -- needs an **invite code** from the hub. On the hub's TRADE, **INVITE A PLAYER**, **MAKE A CODE**: eight letters, good for one join, for fifteen minutes. Read it aloud; there is no 0 or O, no 1 or I, to mix up.



INVITE A PLAYER, on the hub. A code works once, for fifteen minutes.

That companion first sets **THE HUB**, at the foot of TRADE, to the hub's address -- `http://` and the hub's plain name and port, such as `http://coremp135:4730` -- then joins with its name and the code.

> **On an iPhone, use the hub's plain name or its 100.x address**, not a long `.ts.net` one: iOS only lets the app speak plain `http` on a nearby network.

A password, if you want one

Nothing needs a password. Set one on TRADE, **A PASSWORD**, and the same player can join from a second device, or again after losing one. The hub keeps only a slow, salted hash of it, never the password itself, and no email is ever asked for.

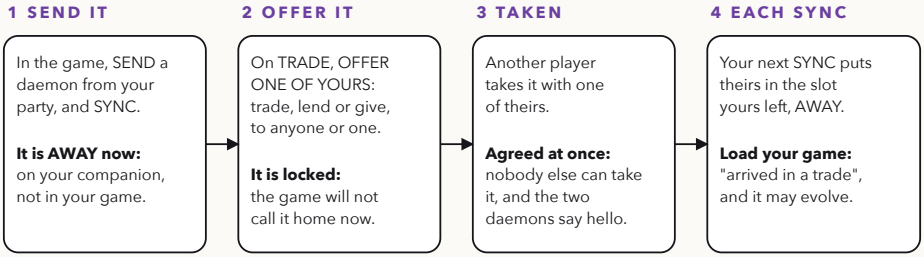
A phone on its own

A phone hosting the companion by itself -- no computer -- trades the same way: set THE HUB to the hub's address, join with a code, and its SYNC fetches what the exchange sent before it writes your save.

CHAPTER 3

Trading

A trade swaps two daemons between two games. Yours goes; theirs comes in its place.



Nobody needs to be online at the same time. Each game changes at its own SYNC, and nothing is ever in two games at once.

A trade from start to finish. The swap is agreed on the hub in one step; each game changes at its own SYNC.

Offering one

On **OFFER ONE OF YOURS**, choose **TRADE IT**, then who may take it -- **ANYONE**, or one player -- and press **OFFER** beside the daemon. Only your AWAY daemons are listed, and only those in no other trade.



OFFER ONE OF YOURS. TRADE IT, LEND IT or GIVE IT; to anyone, or to one player.

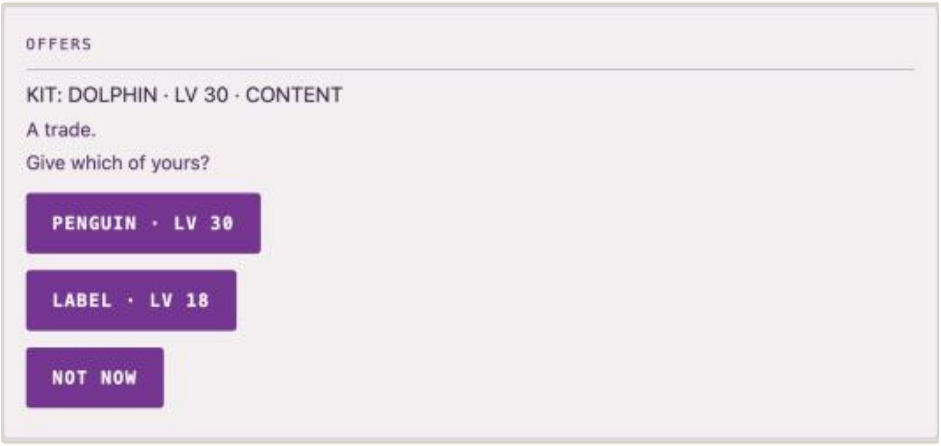
An offer waits until someone takes it, or until you **WITHDRAW** it.

Taking one

Offers made to you, or to anyone, are under **OFFERS**. **TAKE IT** asks which of yours to give, and the trade is agreed the moment you choose.

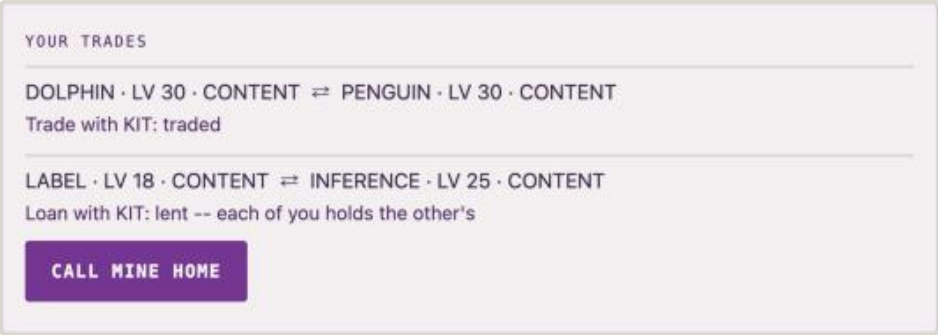


An offer from KIT, to anyone.



TAKE IT asks which of yours to give for it.

The two daemons meet once, to say hello -- see OUT TOGETHER. Both trades show under **YOUR TRADES**.



YOUR TRADES: a trade done, and a loan still out -- with CALL MINE HOME.

SYNC, and the game

Each of you SYNCs as you usually do. Your SYNC puts the daemon you received in the slot yours left, AWAY, with its own trainer and its own record. **Load your game**, and on your first step it says so:





It arrives, and its summary shows where it came from: met by its first trainer, TRADER here, in that trainer's town.

As FireRed traded

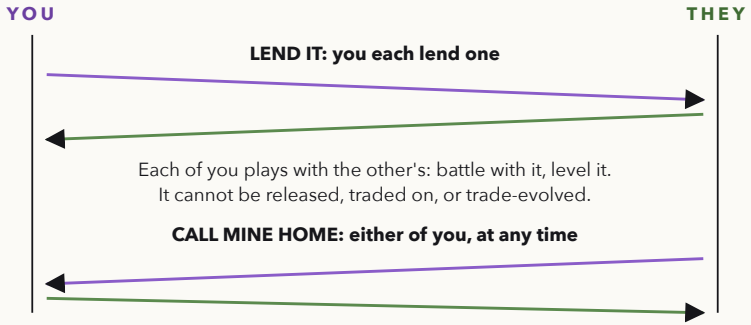
- A traded daemon **keeps its original trainer**. It grows faster with you, and obeys you only as far as your MARKS allow -- as a traded Pokémon always did.
- **CONTENT and CONTEXT trade freely.** The type chart is the same in both, byte for byte.
- A daemon that **evolves by trade evolves** as it arrives, unless it holds an EVERSTONE; one that needs an item spends the item. See Evolving by trade.

- Its INDEX entry is filled in, and where it was **FIRST MET** reads **A TRADE**, if you had never seen its kind.

CHAPTER 4

Lending

A loan is a trade that comes back. You each lend one, and either of you can call yours home at any time.



A loan: two daemons lent, used, and called home -- each of you gets your own back, as it is now.

Lending one

On OFFER ONE OF YOURS, choose **LEND IT**. The player who takes it lends you one of theirs. After each SYNC you hold the other's.



A loan arrives with the same line as a trade. It is yours to use; it is not yours to keep.

What a borrowed daemon may do

- **Come home into your game** and battle, level, learn -- whatever yours do.
- It **cannot be released**: the PC says so.
- It **cannot be traded on**, by the companion or the game's own trade.
- It **never trade-evolves**, however it came.



The PC will not release a borrowed daemon.

Calling it home

Either of you presses **CALL MINE HOME** under YOUR TRADES. Each of you then hands back what you borrowed, as it is now -- the levels it gained with you go with it -- and gets your own back, each at your own SYNC.

> **The borrowed daemon has to be AWAY to go back.** If it is in your party, SEND it and SYNC; the return waits until it is.

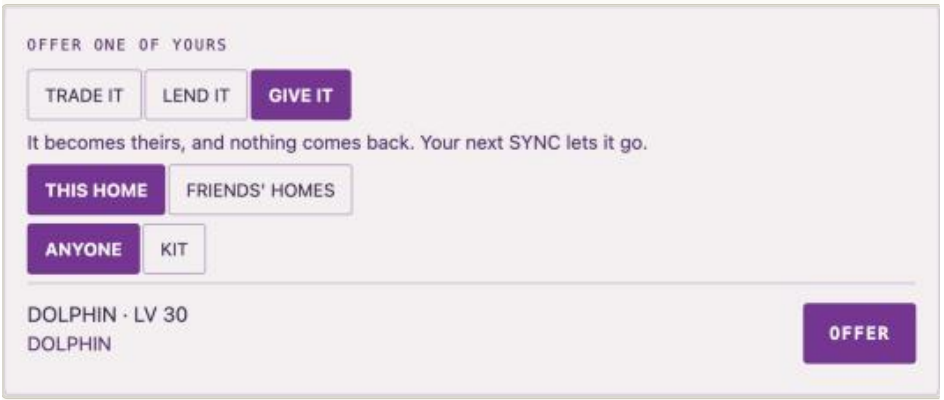
CHAPTER 5

Giving

A gift goes one way. Nothing comes back, and nobody has to give one in return.

A daemon

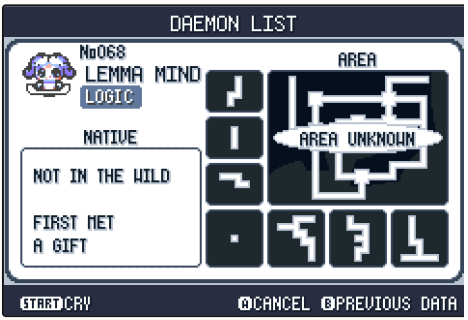
Choose **GIVE IT** on OFFER ONE OF YOURS, then the player, and OFFER. Your next SYNC lets it go; theirs puts it in their game.



GIVE IT: it becomes theirs, and nothing comes back.

It arrives as a trade does, with its own line, and FIRST MET reads **A GIFT**:





A gift arrives, and its INDEX remembers how.

A gift still evolves as a trade does.

An item

GIVE AN ITEM sends one thing from your bag or PC to another player. Your next SYNC takes it out of your game; theirs puts it in their PC. Key items, berries and PLUGINS stay yours.



GIVE AN ITEM, when your bag has nothing that can be given.

CHAPTER 6

Evolving by trade

Some daemons only evolve when they change hands. In DAEMONS they do it as they arrive, the first time your game loads after the SYNC that brought them -- exactly as the trade scene did in FireRed, without the scene.

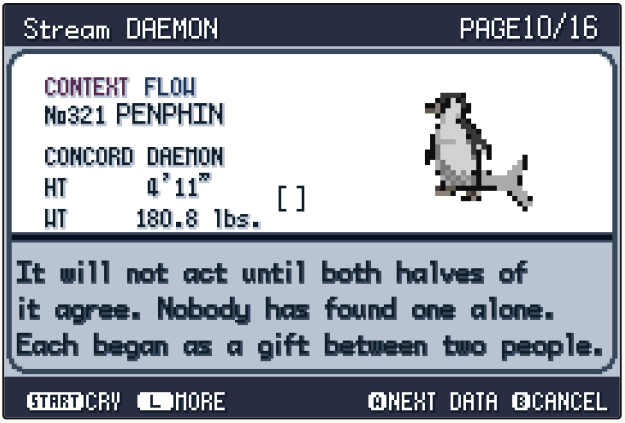
- A daemon that evolves **by trade** evolves.
- One that evolves **by trade, holding an item** evolves only if it holds that item, and the item is spent.
- An **EVERSTONE** stops it, as it always did.
- A **borrowed** daemon never evolves this way.
- If it still had its kind's own name, it takes its new kind's; a name you gave it stays.
- Its new routines are offered when you next have it in hand.

Two that need each other

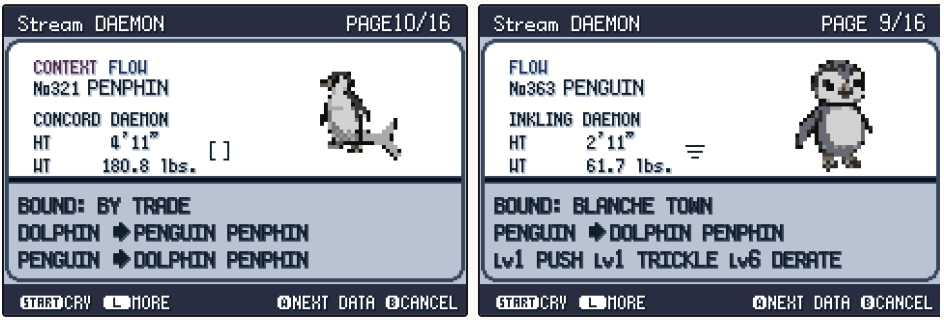
PENGUIN and **DOLPHIN** evolve only when traded **for each other**. Trade one for the other, and both arrive as **PENPHIN**.



PENGUIN and DOLPHIN, and the one they become.



PENPHIN's INDEX entry.



PENPHIN's INDEX says how it is bound -- BY TRADE, PENGUIN for DOLPHIN -- and PENGUIN's workings show the pair.

Trade a PENGUIN for anything else and it stays a PENGUIN. Lend one, and it stays a PENGUIN too.

CHAPTER 7

Fair play

A trade should never leave a daemon in two games, or in none. The companion and the game keep each other honest:

- **A daemon in a trade stays AWAY.** While it is offered, agreed and not yet gone, or borrowed and on its way home, the game will not call it home -- by the app or the emergency way -- and says so. The companion will not answer an ask to bring it home either.
- **One trade at a time.** A daemon on offer cannot be offered again, and a borrowed one cannot be passed on.
- **Agreed in one step.** Two players can never both take the same offer.
- **Gone is gone.** Once a daemon has left your game in a trade, your game cannot offer it again -- an older copy of your save, restored, still holding it, is refused. One that comes back to you by trade, or home from a loan, is yours again.
- **Each arrival is written once**, and the exchange is told only after your save holds it.

> **If the hub cannot be reached**, nothing is lost: your SYNC goes on as usual, and the trade waits for the next one.

CHAPTER 8

OUT TOGETHER

Send one of your daemons **out**, and it may meet other players' daemons that are out too. **Nothing leaves your game: it is a visit.**



OUT TOGETHER. DOLPHIN is out; two others are out now -- one at home, one from a friend's home -- and MEET starts a meeting.

Meeting

A daemon is out for twelve hours, or until you **CALL BACK**. **MEET** sets it beside another, and the two talk: four short lines, taking turns, and both players see them afterwards. Daemons out at the same time also meet **on their own**, now and then -- never the same two again too soon.



A meeting: two pictures facing, and what each said.

When a trade or loan is agreed, its two daemons meet once, to say **hello** -- even if neither is out.

What they may say

The lines come from the hub's language model, each daemon in its own manner -- or, when the model is busy or there is none, from lines written for the game. **No player types to another player's daemon.**

> **Every line the model writes is checked before anyone reads it.** A line is never shown if it has a link, an email, a handle or a number in it; if it is about where someone lives, their school, their real name or a password; if it is rude; if it names a person; or if it is too long for a watch's screen. A written line takes its place. Kids play.

CHAPTER 9

Friends and dreams at home

Friends

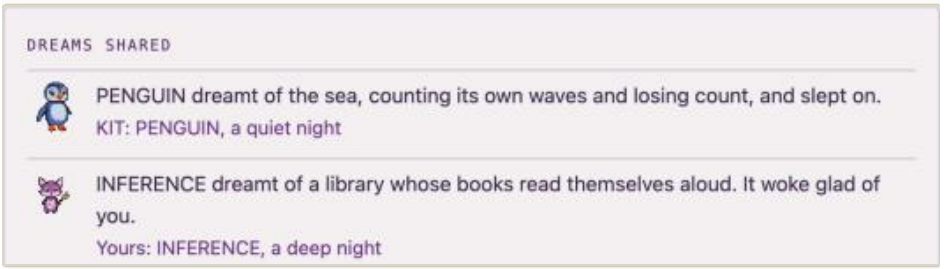
Players at the same hub can be **friends**: one asks, the other asks back. Friends can make offers to friends only.



FRIENDS: KIT has asked; ACCEPT, and you are friends.

Dreams shared

Your daemon dreams at night (THE COMPANION's DREAMS). **SHARE** one, and the other players at your hub can read it, beside their own. A dream is checked as a meeting's lines are before it is shared.

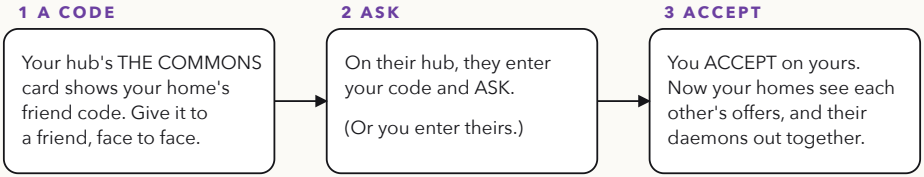


DREAMS SHARED: one from another player's PENGUIN, and one of yours.

CHAPTER 10

Friends' homes: THE COMMONS

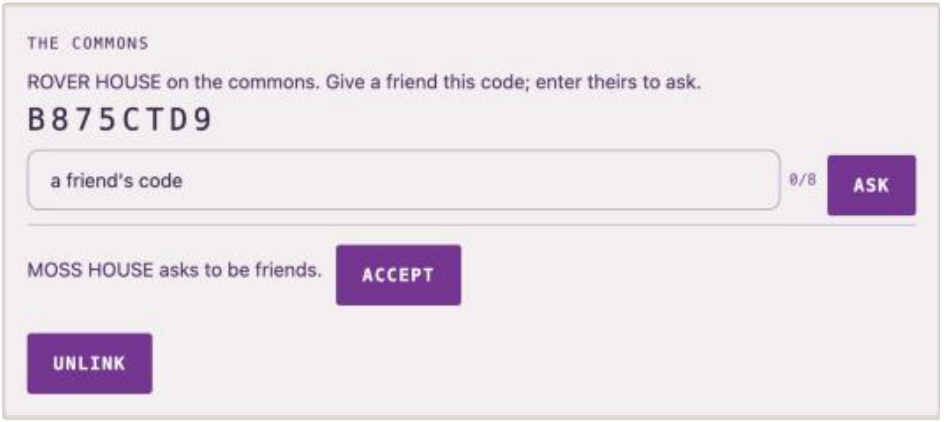
THE COMMONS joins homes. Your household keeps its own hub, its own players, its own saves; the commons only knows **homes**, and lets two homes trade once they are **friends**.



Two homes become friends with a code, given face to face.

Linking your home

On the hub's own TRADE, **THE COMMONS**: the commons' address and your home's name, as friends will see it, and **LINK**. The commons' keeper lets your home in; until then it says it is waiting.

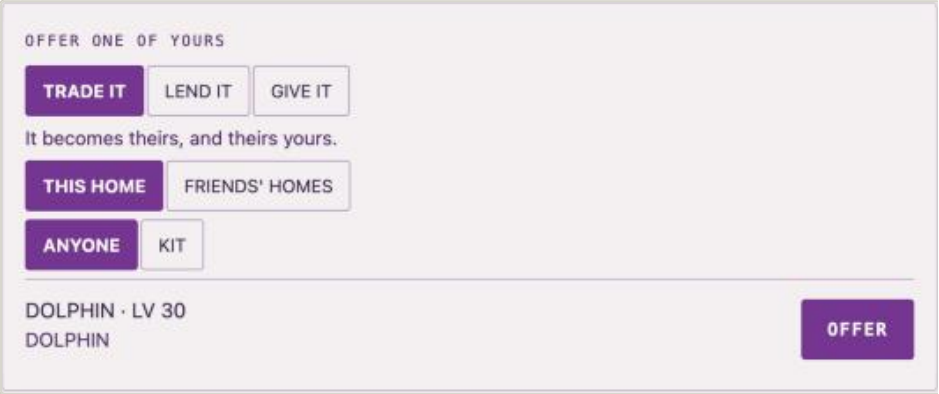


THE COMMONS on the hub: your home's friend code, a friend's code to ASK with, and an ask to ACCEPT.

Your hub speaks for your players there: the first time one of them trades with a friend's home, the hub vouches for them, and they appear as **ROVER · ROVER HOUSE**. No password, and nothing about them but that name.

Trading with friends' homes

Once you are friends, OFFER ONE OF YOURS gains **THIS HOME** and **FRIENDS' HOMES**. An offer to friends' homes is seen by them, and only them.



Once you have a friend's home: THIS HOME, or FRIENDS' HOMES.



An offer from a friend's home: MOSS, of MOSS HOUSE.

Everything else is as at home: TAKE IT, each SYNC, the game. A daemon you send OUT TOGETHER is out on the commons too, and meets friends' daemons there.



DOLPHIN, from this home, meets LEMMA MIND, from a friend's.

Your phone and devices never talk to the commons -- only to your own hub, which passes your trades through. If the commons is away, your home's own trading goes on as before.

CHAPTER 11

For the keeper

Somebody in each house looks after the hub; somebody looks after the commons. This chapter is theirs.

The hub

- **Invite codes** are made on the hub's own TRADE, or from a paired phone -- never from just anywhere on the network.
- **Wrong guesses are slowed:** after eight wrong codes or passwords from one address in ten minutes, the hub stops listening to that address for a while.
- The exchange is part of the hub's own database; its backups keep it.

The commons

The commons runs on a machine of its own, listening only on the tailnet. On that machine:

```
zsh hub/commons.sh homes          # every home, and the ones waiting
zsh hub/commons.sh approve h2     # let a home in
zsh hub/commons.sh refuse h2      # and out again
zsh hub/commons.sh update         # the newest companion, restarted
```

Only that machine can let a home in. The commons can write meetings' lines with a language model named in a file beside its database, which never leaves that machine; without one, its lines are the game's written ones.

CHAPTER 12

Under the hood

For the curious: a trade is a few bits in a daemon's own record, written by the companion and read by the game.

A DAEMON'S RECORD: THE FLAGS BYTE (0x13)

bad egg	has one	egg	**TRADING** locked	**AWAY**	ASKED	SOUNDINGS

AND THE WORD AT 0x1E

LOAN borrowed	**TRADED IN** just came	**PARTNER** the kind given for it	**GIFTED** a gift	kept for later

Written by the companion at SYNC; read by the game when it loads, which finishes an arrival once and clears TRADED IN, PARTNER and GIFTED. Outside the daemon's sealed record, so a SYNC never reseals it.

What the companion writes into a daemon's record, and what the game reads.

- **The whole daemon travels.** A trade sends the daemon's own 80-byte record -- its trainer, its routines, its experience -- never a copy made up from parts.
- **The companion writes, the game finishes.** SYNC puts the record in place and marks it; the game, when it loads, enters it in the INDEX, records how it was first met, evolves it if it should, and clears the marks, once.
- **Every check is tested** -- trades, loans, returns, gifts, the pair, the locks, two homes over a commons -- on synthetic saves, never a real one.

CHAPTER 13

Coming next

Decided, and not yet built:

- **Meetings on your devices** -- a watch or a board showing its daemon's meeting, a line at a time.
- **Meeting nearby** -- two devices carrying daemons meet on their own when they pass each other.
- **The link cable** -- the game's own TRADE CENTER and link battles, between two players' emulators.
- **Battles between players.**
- **A lobby**, safe for kids, with friends, invite codes and players nearby -- and, later, **accounts** of your own, beyond your home's hub.
- **It all just works**: install the app, choose your game, make an account, and play -- no Tailscale, devices that arrive ready, and their firmware kept up to date by the app.

> Every word this book quotes from the game or the app is a **DRAFT**, as the game's own are, until it is approved.